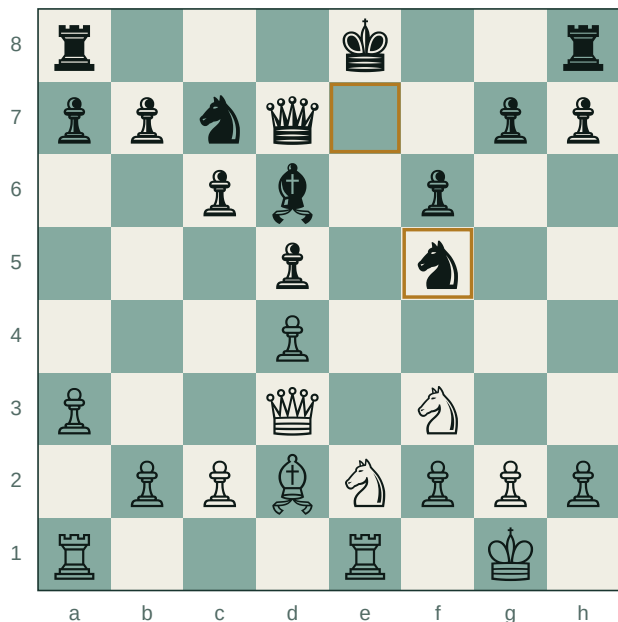


# Discovered checks: White, move 14

Discovered checks

White to move



Previous move: 13...Nf5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**14. Ng3+ Ne7 15. Nf5 O-O 16. Nxd6**

**14.Ng3+** Check restricts Black to 10 legal replies here. The changed line means the rook on e1 attacks the king on e8. Recorded reply: **14...Ne7**.

**15.Nf5** The knight moves from g3 to f5. From f5 it attacks knight on e7 and bishop on d6. Recorded reply: **15...O-O**.

**16.Nxd6** The knight captures the bishop on d6.

At the end, nominal material is White 35 / Black 32 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

## CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

## HOW TO LOOK

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8. Check for tactical protection.